visits (which I repeated to this as well as many other prisons much oftener than the times when I took the numbers) some had the smallpox. It was so crowded the summer 1776, that a prisoner paid five shillings a week for half a bed, and many lay in the chapel. In May 1776, the number of prisoners within the walls was 395; and by an accurate list which I procured, their wives (including a few that were only called so) were 279, children 725, total 1004: about two-thirds of these were in the prison.

The above was the state of the prison in 1776; but afterwards some of the old buildings were taken down, and a chapel and many rooms added to the new buildings, and another wing similar to that which has been already mentioned, but no infirmary. This spacious prison is enclosed with a strong wall about thirty feet high, with a *chevaux de frise*.

The rules, or bounds of this prison are extensive, including St. George's Fields, one side of Blackman Street, and part of the Borough High Street.

This prison is visited at Michaelmas term, as the Act directs;[1] yet at my first visits there was a wine club, and a beer club; and one could scarcely ever enter the walls without seeing parties at skittles, mississippi, portobello, tennis, fives, etc.

The above was the account of the prison before it was burnt by the rioters in 1780: and now it is rebuilt on the plan of the former new buildings. No infirmary. Many good regulations are introduced, and a stop is put in a great measure to gaming and the illicit practice of selling spirituous liquors and smuggled goods.

The tables of rules and orders for the government of this prison are hung up (as required by the preamble) for common inspection. I presume to give an abridgment of them.

RULES and ORDERS for the better Government, etc. Made and signed the 25th of November, 1729

1. The stocks to be kept up for punishment of blasphemers, swearers, riotous, etc.
2. Against illegal methods of confinement. None to be confined in an unusual place or manner, unless for attempting to escape. And such may appeal to the court, or a judge.
3. Marshal not to remove any to the Fleet by writ of habeas corpus.
4. Marshal not to remove any one from the common-side and its benefits without three days' notice: during which time, the prisoner may appeal to a judge.

[1] Thirty-second George II.

5. Coroner's inquest upon the dead.
6. Against garnish and partial distribution of dividends.
7. Prisoners to send out for necessaries; and to bring in their own bedding, etc.
8. Table of fees, these rules, and a list of charities to be hung up in a public room.
9. Marshal and servants to behave with the utmost tenderness.
10. Turnkey always to attend at the door.
11. No servants to partake of, or even distribute the charity.
12. Chapel to be kept in repair. Chaplain duly to perform.
13. The abusive to the stocks.
14. Dining-room to be kept in repair for devotion, or conversation: with a fire. Two rooms for the sick.
15. Those who make oath before, etc., that they have not £5, etc., to be admitted to the charities, offices in the prison, etc.
16. No person committed for any criminal matter to vote for steward, etc., or to partake of any charity but the baskets.
17. Lodging in the cabin of any ward, gratis.
18. Any prisoner may be chosen assistant, and enjoy the benefits of that station.
19. The seal of the common-side to be kept by the master of King's Bench office: and not put to any deed without the approbation of marshal, steward, and assistants.
20. One supersedable action may be superseded with common-side money: more than one, not without application to the court, or a judge. No judge's clerk to take a fee on the occasion.
21. The sick to be taken care of by the steward and assistants: who are to be reimbursed out of the first county-money.
22. Debts contracted by the steward and assistants with the marshal's and master's consent, for support of the poor, to be paid out of the next dividend.
23. Steward and assistants to have no pay for common business, or adjusting differences.
24. Prisoners entered after the first day of Easter-term, to have but one quarter of the Midsummer dividend.
25. All money brought in by the basket-men, or brought in at Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, to be divided immediately after paying the basket-men for their trouble.
26. If the marshal advance money for a *supersedeas*, he is to be reimbursed out of the next county-money.
27. Common-side prisoners may elect an annual steward; who is not to be deposed, but on application to the court or a judge. No prisoner in the rules may vote.
28. The steward to enter in books the table of fees, these rules, and a list of the charities. All, together with his accounts, for inspection of the prisoners.
29. A prisoner wronged by the steward and assistants, on applying